



1 On the surface

To the unaided eye, this carpet looks perfectly normal and clean, but zooming in with a microscope reveals the hidden world of dirt, dust, and mysterious creatures crawling beneath our feet.



2 A little closer

Under a microscope, the individual fibers of the carpet can be seen clearly, as well as tiny bits of dust and some microscopic animals. This level of magnification is possible with a light microscope.



3 Seeing the invisible

Under a more advanced microscope, tiny dust mites, which are distant relatives of spiders, become visible. These creatures feast on tiny flakes of dead skin that humans constantly shed and are a common cause of allergies.

The average mattress is thought to contain around **2 million** microscopic dust mites.

